

waging war on civilians while not performing well in battle. At Cross Keys and at Second Bull Run, the German regiments of the East fought well, despite poor generalship; while early Union victories in the West, such as Pea Ridge, where Franz Sigel and many German units fought courageously, were downplayed.

By the summer of 1863, however, Irish and German-American soldiers and civilians had come to share something: a feeling of indignation and disenchantment with the Union war effort. The Irish Brigade had shrunk to a shell of its former self. Recruitment dropped off due to Irish dissatisfaction with Emancipation, state draft laws, economic hardship at home, and a perception that they had been used as cannon fodder in previous battles.



### **German soldiers at Second Bull Run**

The German units of Franz Sigel's First Corps were heavily engaged at Stony Ridge and Henry House Hill on August 29 and 30, during the Second Battle of Bull Run, but their badly coordinated attacks were unsuccessful.